
[ICCSO Board] SAVE spending, SAVE budget, How much money is left? Capital Projects Wants v. Needs,

board@iowacityschools.org 'Mary Murphy' via Board

Monday, October 21, 2024 at 2:20:26 PM Central Daylight Time

To: mg9425@yahoo.com Mary Murphy
To: board@iowacityschools.org Board

Dear Board Members,

My children have graduated; however, since I could have grandchildren go to school here someday and viewed your *Center for Innovation Pathways to Purpose PowerPoint* presentation, I am writing to ask you to **NOT support or pay for a remodel at the Center for Innovation for the following reasons.**

1. First and foremost, I would not have wanted my own students to spend more time on screens. It hampers concentration. It is ironic to put students on more screens at a time when you're considering limiting cell phone use. If career information is valuable for students to have, come up with other less expensive, less screen-oriented ways to teach and share it and consider using the schools you have to do so.
2. The financial audit for fiscal year 2023 is not back yet. Fiscal year 2022's audit was filed by February 15, 2023.
3. ICCSD has competing capital needs and no public long-term financial budget for SAVE. **The public has not been told how much SAVE money has been spent and committed, nor has the public been informed how much SAVE money is left and available to spend through 2050.** Competing priorities--preschool center(s), Coralville athletic facility, other athletic facilities, future building and repair needs, etc.—should be prioritized and budgeted for now **before** SAVE dollars/capital funds are committed.
 - a. What SAVE dollars will be kept in reserve for unanticipated future needs?
 - b. Is the current SAVE reserve, if any, and on top of what the state requires, sufficient?

Please provide a **SAVE budget and SAVE financial projections to 2050** and have serious **public discussions** involving the community about **competing future priorities and needs (not wants)** that will require SAVE dollars.

4. If ICCSD has capital needs, including big ticket maintenance items, in the future before 2050 and runs out of SAVE dollars, ICCSD has two primary potential sources of money
 - a. ICCSD can have bond vote, which may be difficult to pass with vouchers, or
 - b. ICCSD can sell school buildings because the proceeds are deposited in the PPEL fund.

Schools should not close in the future because ICCSD is spending SAVE/capital project dollars now on current wants instead of needs and then has so little capital project money for the future, it is forced to sell school buildings to pay for them.

5. I do **not** believe the statement in the PowerPoint that these wants are "All capital costs, no general fund impact." At a minimum, ICCSD will spend general fund dollars on bussing, housekeeping, and employee time. These general fund dollars would be better directed toward providing, for example, more students with Spanish, which is a real-world employment skill. Just because Junior Achievement can raise money for five years for ICCSD (assuming it can be done) does **not** mean ICCSD should move forward with this project. An evaluation should also be done to see if Junior Achievement raising money for school wants impacts ICCSD and the foundation's ability to raise money for actual school needs and not wants.
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8. Voting yes on this capital spending and other big-ticket items hamstrings future boards' ability to spend SAVE dollars on future needs out to the year 2050. Not having money for future capital projects could hurt ICCSD's ability to

be competitive long term.

I realize that the PowerPoint is a presentation; however, please examine and publicly discuss all potential future competing SAVE funded projects and put together a budget for SAVE to 2050. Also consider not spending money for at least a couple of years to determine what exactly is a capital project need that will improve academic outcomes and not a want and how much money is left.

Thank you for your service.

Sincerely,

Mary Murphy

ruthina.malone@iowacityschools.org Ruthina Malone

Monday, October 21, 2024 at 2:55:18 PM Central
Daylight Time

To: degner.matt@iowacityschools.org Matt Degner, ramey.chace@iowacityschools.org Chace Ramey
Cc: kurth.adam@iowacityschools.org Adam Kurth

FYI

Regards,
Ruthina
Ruthina A. Malone (she/her)
President, Board of Education
Iowa City Community School District
<https://www.iowacityschools.org>

----- Forwarded message -----

From: 'Mary Murphy' via Board <board@iowacityschools.org>

Date: Mon, Oct 21, 2024, 2:20 PM

Subject: [ICCSB Board] SAVE spending, SAVE budget, How much money is left? Capital Projects Wants v. Needs,

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Sincerely,

Mary Murphy

degner.matt@iowacityschools.org Matt Degner

Monday, October 21, 2024 at 2:55:47 PM Central
Daylight Time

To: ruthina.malone@iowacityschools.org Ruthina Malone

Thanks Ruthina.

Matt

Matt Degner

Superintendent

Iowa City Community School District
Educational Services Center
1725 North Dodge St.



**IOWA CITY COMMUNITY
SCHOOL DISTRICT**
All In for All Kids

On Mon, Oct 21, 2024 at 2:55 PM Ruthina Malone <ruthina.malone@iowacityschools.org> wrote:
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Sincerely,

Mary Murphy

mitch.lingo@iowacityschools.org Mitch Lingo

Tuesday, October 22, 2024 at 12:53:47 PM Central
Daylight Time

To: degner.matt@iowacityschools.org Matt Degner

Hello Matt,

I hope your day is going well. I would also like to know how much of our SAVE money (to 2050) is committed through the FMP 2.2 \$274M budget. Are we only committing SAVE money up until 2030, or are we committing money all the way out to 2050, or somewhere in between? I do not believe that the question is that 'far out there,' and I have seen it multiple times on message boards and have been asked about it in the community. And, as I said before, I want to make sure that I leave future boards in a flexible position if they cannot get a PPLE extension passed.

Thanks,

Mitch

Mitchell Lingo, Ph.D. (he/him/his)
Board of Directors

Iowa City Community School District
www.iowacityschools.org

On Mon, Oct 21, 2024 at 2:20 PM 'Mary Murphy' via Board <board@iowacityschools.org> wrote:

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Mary Murphy

degner.matt@iowacityschools.org Matt Degner

Tuesday, October 22, 2024 at 1:03:21 PM Central
Daylight Time

To: kurth.adam@iowacityschools.org Adam Kurth

Hey Adam,

Can you give me some specifics to get back to him on? I looked at the Debt History and Projections document, but I don't think that is answering the question. I know you have probably told me this before, so my apologies.

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Matt Degner

Superintendent

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Educational Services Center
1725 North Dodge St.
Iowa City, Iowa 52240
www.IowaCitySchools.org



**IOWA CITY COMMUNITY
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All In for All Kids

----- Forwarded message -----

From: **Mitch Lingo** <mitch.lingo@iowacityschools.org>

Date: Tue, Oct 22, 2024 at 12:53 PM

Subject: Fwd: [ICCSd Board] SAVE spending, SAVE budget, How much money is left? Capital Projects Wants v. Needs,

To: Matt Degner <degner.matt@iowacityschools.org>

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Board of Directors
Iowa City Community School District
www.iowacityschools.org

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Thank you for your service.

Sincerely,

Mary Murphy

kurth.adam@iowacityschools.org Adam Kurth

Tuesday, October 22, 2024 at 4:44:45 PM Central
Daylight Time

To: degner.matt@iowacityschools.org Matt Degner

Hey Matt,

I replied via text as well, but now that I'm getting to this email I wanted to provide a little more context. We will be paying existing SAVE revenue bonds through FY2038, though the portion of our SAVE revenues that those comprise is likely to drop each year as our SAVE revenues increase. That is to say that we can certainly issue additional revenue bonds prior to 2038, which could either utilize additional capacity made available through revenue increases, or through restructuring existing debt to extend the repayment period. Currently, we have no SAVE obligations that extend beyond FY2038, and no debt repayments at all that extend beyond FY2039.

One additional item that I wanted to share is that our PPEL authorization runs through 2035, and a PPEL revenue bond that was issued ten years ago will be fully paid this year. The payments on this represent just under \$1M of our annual PPEL expenditures, so that ultimately frees up those funds for either a) expansion of PPEL-funded projects, or b) issuance of a new PPEL revenue bond that would be payable through FY2035 (we'd want to issue in summer, 2025, most likely).

Cheers,

Adam Kurth

Chief Financial Officer

Iowa City Community School District
(319) 688-1000

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degner.matt@iowacityschools.org Matt Degner

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To: kurth.adam@iowacityschools.org Adam Kurth

Hi Adam,
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Matt

Matt Degner

Superintendent

Iowa City Community School District
Educational Services Center
1725 North Dodge St.
Iowa City, Iowa 52240



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(319) 688-1000

www.iowacityschools.org



On Tue, Oct 22, 2024 at 1:03 PM Matt Degner <degner.matt@iowacityschools.org> wrote:

Hey Adam,

Can you give me some specifics to get back to him on? I looked at the Debt History and Projections document, but I don't think that is answering the question. I know you have probably told me this before, so my apologies.

Matt

Matt Degner

Superintendent

Iowa City Community School District

Educational Services Center

1725 North Dodge St.

Iowa City, Iowa 52240

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----- Forwarded message -----

From: **Mitch Lingo** <mitch.lingo@iowacityschools.org>

Date: Tue, Oct 22, 2024 at 12:53 PM

Subject: Fwd: [ICCSd Board] SAVE spending, SAVE budget, How much money is left? Capital Projects Wants v. Needs,

To: Matt Degner <degner.matt@iowacityschools.org>

Hello Matt,

I hope your day is going well. I would also like to know how much of our SAVE money (to 2050) is committed through the FMP 2.2 \$274M budget. Are we only committing SAVE money up until 2030, or are we committing money all the way out to 2050, or somewhere in between? I do not believe that the question is that 'far out there,' and I have seen it multiple times on message boards and have been asked about it in the community. And, as I said before, I want to make sure that I leave future boards in a flexible position if they cannot get a PPLE extension passed.

Thanks,

Mitch

Mitchell Lingo, Ph.D. (he/him/his)
Board of Directors
Iowa City Community School District
www.iowacityschools.org

On Mon, Oct 21, 2024 at 2:20 PM 'Mary Murphy' via Board <board@iowacityschools.org> wrote:

Dear Board Members,

My children have graduated; however, since I could have grandchildren go to school here someday and viewed your *Center for Innovation Pathways to Purpose PowerPoint* presentation, I am writing to ask you to **NOT support or pay for a remodel at the Center for Innovation for the following reasons.**

1. First and foremost, I would not have wanted my own students to spend more time on screens. It hampers concentration. It is ironic to put students on more screens at a time when you're considering limiting cell phone use. If career information is valuable for students to have, come up with other less expensive, less screen-oriented ways to teach and share it and consider using the schools you have to do so.
2. The financial audit for fiscal year 2023 is not back yet. Fiscal year 2022's audit was filed by February 15, 2023.
3. ICCSD has competing capital needs and no public long-term financial budget for SAVE. **The public has not been told how much SAVE money has been spent and committed, nor has the public been informed how much SAVE money is left and available to spend through 2050.** Competing priorities--preschool center(s), Coralville athletic facility, other athletic facilities, future building and repair needs, etc.—should be prioritized and budgeted for now **before** SAVE dollars/capital funds are committed.
 - a. What SAVE dollars will be kept in reserve for unanticipated future needs?
 - b. Is the current SAVE reserve, if any, and on top of what the state requires, sufficient?

Please provide a **SAVE budget and SAVE financial projections to 2050** and have serious **public discussions** involving the community about **competing future priorities and needs (not wants)** that will require SAVE dollars.

4. If ICCSD has capital needs, including big ticket maintenance items, in the future before 2050 and runs out of SAVE dollars, ICCSD has two primary potential sources of money

- a. ICCSD can have bond vote, which may be difficult to pass with vouchers, or
- b. ICCSD can sell school buildings because the proceeds are deposited in the PPEL fund.

Schools should not close in the future because ICCSD is spending SAVE/capital project dollars now on current wants instead of needs and then has so little capital project money for the future, it is forced to sell school buildings to pay for them.

5. I do **not** believe the statement in the PowerPoint that these wants are “All capital costs, no general fund impact.” At a minimum, ICCSD will spend general fund dollars on bussing, housekeeping, and employee time. These general fund dollars would be better directed toward providing, for example, more students with Spanish, which is a real-world employment skill. Just because Junior Achievement can raise money for five years for ICCSD (assuming it can be done) does **not** mean ICCSD should move forward with this project. An evaluation should also be done to see if Junior Achievement raising money for school wants impacts ICCSD and the foundation's ability to raise money for actual school needs and not wants.

6. If this project is so vital, which it is NOT, then it is one where the capital expense should be shared by other school districts.

7. With vouchers, ICCSD needs to compete with private schools. I would have moved my children for better academics but **not** this renovation.

8. Voting yes on this capital spending and other big-ticket items hamstrings future boards' ability to spend SAVE dollars on future needs out to the year 2050. Not having money for future capital projects could hurt ICCSD's ability to be competitive long term.

I realize that the PowerPoint is a presentation; however, please examine and publicly discuss all potential future competing SAVE funded projects and put together a budget for SAVE to 2050. Also consider not spending money for at least a couple of years to determine what exactly is a capital project need that will improve academic outcomes and not a want and how much money is left.

Thank you for your service.

Sincerely,

Mary Murphy